Army Operations

Quick briefing

Distinguish the platforms, operation types, tenets and principles used in the Philippine Army lesson, then apply them to a classroom coordination decision.

Know the facts

Constitutional mandate · The lesson cites Article II of the 1987 Constitution. The AFP protects the people and the State, with the goal of securing State sovereignty and national territorial integrity.

Operational platforms · Multinational or combined operations involve an alliance or coalition. Joint operations involve forces from two or more services under a single commander. Combined arms integrates several Army arms.

Full spectrum operations · The lesson groups these into offensive operations, defensive operations and support to civil governance.

Support to civil governance · Lesson examples include disaster response, civil population and vital installation security, and support to community development.

Five tenets · Initiative, agility, depth, synchronization and versatility describe qualities of effective Army operations.

Army power and principles · The lesson presents Army power through warfighting functions tied together by leadership. Principles such as objective, unity of command and simplicity help assess operational choices.

Understand the reasoning

The operation type describes the activity’s purpose. The platform describes how the participating forces are organized. A disaster-response activity can also involve more than one service.

Synchronization makes interdependent activities work in time and space. In a relief exercise, a shared handoff time and location can prevent supplies from arriving before the receiving team is ready.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

A fictional Philippine Army classroom team supports a municipal disaster drill. Transport can bring training supplies to a shelter before the receiving team is ready, or wait for the shelter's confirmed intake window.

Decision · Which course better applies synchronization, and what is the tradeoff?

Worked analysis · Use the confirmed intake window and communicate the handoff to both teams. Arrival may be later, but the supplies are more likely to be accepted and distributed immediately. Keep the coordination simple by naming the handoff lead and the update that triggers a change.

Check yourself

What are the lesson's three elements of full spectrum operations? · Offensive operations, defensive operations and support to civil governance.

Which tenet arranges activities in time and space so their effects come together? · Synchronization.

Course source

Introduction to Army Operations